Within blocks of code, a # character at the start of a line indicates that what follows the # is the result of evaluating the immediately preceding line:

```
read = (material) ->
  console.log "Reading #{material}"

read 'CoffeeScript in Action'
# Reading CoffeeScript in Action
```

In this way, all of the code snippets can be pasted directly into a CoffeeScript prompt, where the output you see should match the comment. A similar approach is taken with JavaScript code snippets where # is replaced with `//`:

```
'Raw' + ' JavaScript'
// 'Raw JavaScript'
```

Formatted code snippets can be copied and pasted from HTML files, one for each chapter, which are available for download from the publisher's website and also from links inside eBook versions of *CoffeeScript in Action*.

Invoking programs on the command line is shown by prefixing each line with a `>`. Expected output is prefixed with a #:

```
> coffee -e "console.log(3 + 4);"
# 7
```

Being prefixed with a `>`, the command-line examples have the disadvantage that they can't be pasted directly into a prompt. Occasionally, to provide a clear distinction between general command lines and the prompt for a particular program, the listing is prefixed with the name of the program prompt followed by a `>`:

```
node>
```

Before you can run any of this code, you need to have CoffeeScript installed.

Installing CoffeeScript